

Learning With Music: Top 10 Love Songs [B2]

Non c'è niente di più romantico che dedicare una canzone d'amore. Eccone 10 intramontabili con cui fare colpo!



Love is a predominant [theme](#) of almost all musical genres, particularly pop music. A 2018 study found that 67.3 per cent of chart hits from 1960 to 2010 were about the emotional happiness or torment associated with this multifaceted emotion. With tales of [undying](#) devotion or of the anguish of a broken heart, bards have used romantic serenades since songwriting began to [pull at listeners' heartstrings](#) with a subject that almost everyone can relate to. We list a selection of the greatest love songs to help with your English and to fill your heart!

A2 PRE-INTERMEDIATE

[Hailed](#) by Frank Sinatra as the greatest love song of “the last fifty or one hundred years” (although he mis[take](#)nly attributed it to principal Beatles songwriters John Lennon and Paul McCartney,) it was initially believed that guitarist George Harrison wrote this for his [then-wife](#) Patti Boyd. He later denied this in a 1976 interview, claiming it was about the Hindu [deity](#) Krishna: “When you love a woman, it’s the God in her that you see.” The simple and evocative lyrics use the present simple to make comparisons. Something in the way she movesAttracts me like no other loverSomething in the way she [woos](#) me Perhaps Stevie Wonder’s most famous song, it remains the US singer-songwriter’s best-selling single to date, reaching number one in 28 countries worldwide at the time of its [release](#).

Featuring on the soundtrack of the romantic comedy The Woman In Red, written and directed by Gene Wilder, who also [starred in the film opposite](#) Kelly LeBrock, the song won both an Oscar and Golden Globe. Listing all the reasons someone might telephone a loved one, but not actually needing any, this song includes easy and useful vocabulary with the use of ‘to’ for objectives. No New Year’s Day to celebrateNo chocolate covered candy hearts to give awayNo first of spring, no song to singIn fact, here’s just another ordinary day Better known as a goth band, The Cure surprised fans with what singer Robert Smith referred to as a “[dumb](#) pop song.” In one of their most successful and [upbeat](#) songs, the singer celebrates his joy of being with his loved one at the weekend, [dismissing](#) her on weekdays. Using just the present simple and repeatedly listing the days of the week, this song is ideal for low level learners. I don’t care if Monday’s blueTuesday’s grey and Wednesday’s tooThursday, I don’t care about youIt’s Friday, I’m in loveMonday you can [fall apart](#)Tuesday, Wednesday break my heartOh, Thursday doesn’t even startIt’s Friday, I’m in love Conceived as the [theme](#) to a quickly forgotten 1955 film called Unchained, this is one of the most covered songs of all time. On its initial [release](#), there were four versions simultaneously in the charts. The [Righteous](#) Brothers’ [take](#) was originally a B-side, but radio DJs preferred it to the A-side and it became a huge hit. Twenty-five years later, when it soundtracked Patrick Swayze and Demi Moore’s [highly-charged pottery](#) scene in the film Ghost, it became 1990’s biggest-selling single. The song opens with the present perfect and uses simple ‘yes/no’ questions. Oh, my love, my darlingI’ve [hungered for](#) your touchA long, lonely timeAnd time goes by so slowlyAnd time can do so muchAre you still mine? Entertainment

Learning With Music: Top 10 David Bowie Songs In oltre cinquant'anni di carriera, il re della metamorfosi ci ha regalato pezzi indimenticabili. Ecco dieci dei suoi migliori brani. Fergal Kavanagh , Sarah Davison

B1 LOWER-INTERMEDIATE

Elvis's publishing deal stipulated that he receive a 50 per cent writing credit, but neither he nor co-credited Vera Matson wrote Love Me Tender. Songwriter Ken Darby, Matson's husband, used the melody of the 1861 American Civil War song Aura Lee to accompany this sentimental declaration of eternal love. Shortly before its [release](#), Elvis performed the song on television, [prompting](#) unprecedented pre-sales of over a million copies. The lyrics use imperatives and the present perfect, but begin with two incorrect adverbs — he should be asking her to love him 'tenderly' and 'sweetly'. Love me tender, love me sweet Never let me go You have made my life complete And I love you so Irish singer Sinéad O'Connor's cover of a little-known track by US superstar Prince propelled her to [superstardom](#) and reached number one in eighteen countries. A [heart-wrenching plea](#) from an abandoned lover, one reviewer called it "the loveliest of love songs." The lyrics detail the [void](#) created by the ending of a relationship, opening with an example of the present perfect with 'since'. It's been seven hours and fifteen days Since you took your love away I go out every night and sleep all day Since you took your love away Since you've been gone, I can do whatever I want I can see [whomever](#) I choose I can eat my dinner in a [fancy](#) restaurant But nothing, I said, nothing can [take](#) away these [blues](#) Written for the film Robin Hood: Prince of Thieves starring Kevin Costner and Mary Elizabeth Mastrantonio, this power ballad soon took on a life of its own. Although it alienated some fans of Bryan Adams' earlier rock style, it brought him to a whole new audience and this became one of the best-selling singles ever. The song, which Adams claims he "[knocked out](#) in about forty-five minutes", is a heartfelt declaration of love using imperatives, the future 'will' and 'when' as a conjunction. Look into my eyes You will see What you mean to me Search your heart Search your soul And when you find me there You'll search no more

B2 UPPER INTERMEDIATE

[Concerned](#) that 2014's [corny](#) romantic ballad Thinking Out Loud would be his defining song, Ed Sheeran [set out](#) to write what became the most successful song of his career. A serenade to his [wife-to-be](#), reflecting on their past, present and future, this captured the hearts of millions of listeners, with duets performed with Beyoncé and Andrea Bocelli bringing it to an even wider audience. The lyrics use the past simple, future, imperatives and descriptive adjectives. I found a love for me Oh, darling, just [dive right in](#) and follow my [lead](#) Well, I found a girl, beautiful and sweet Oh, I never knew you were the someone waitin' for me [Mistakenly](#)

perceived as a romantic [paeon](#), this is in fact a [prayer](#). English poet Brian Hinton compared the lyrics to Dante, naming it “one of the finest love songs of the century.” It was only a minor hit for Morrison but a cover by Rod Stewart was hugely successful in 1993. The song’s title and opening line were [pilfered](#) from a 1968 soul song and are an example of a question in the present perfect. Have I told you lately that I love you? Have I told you there’s no one above you? Fill my heart with [gladness](#) Take away my sadness [Ease](#) my troubles, that’s what you do

The best-selling single of all time by a female solo artist, Whitney Houston recorded this pop-ballad cover of a 1973 Dolly Parton country song for movie *The Bodyguard*, in which she made her debut as an actor [alongside](#) Kevin Costner, the quintessential romantic [lead](#) of 1990s cinema. The original was a [farewell](#) to Parton’s business manager as she embarked on a solo career, but Whitney turned it into a [tear-jerking](#) acceptance that her relationship, though still loving, was over. The lyrics use mixed conditionals and modals ‘should’ and ‘would’. If I should stay I would only be in your way So I’ll go, but I know I’ll think of you every step of the way And I will always love you I will always love you Click here and listen to the Spotify playlist with the Top 10 love songs of all time. Fergal Kavanagh runs the website www.tuneintoenglish.com, the web’s largest free resource for learning English through pop music. Click here and you’ll have access to the worksheets for the songs included in this article.

Glossary

- **prayer** = preghiera
- **starred in the film opposite** = recitare con
- **upbeat** = allegre
- **plea** = supplica
- **set out** = decidersi
- **farewell** = addio
- **superstardom** = status di celebrità
- **corny** = sdolcinata
- **Righteous** = giusti
- **release** = uscita
- **gladness** = gioia
- **Hailed** = elogiare
- **then-wife** = allora moglie
- **deity** = divinità
- **heart-wrenching** = struggente
- **knocked out** = buttare giù
- **dive right in** = buttarsi, lanciarsi
- **take** = versione
- **pull at listeners' heartstrings** = commuovere profondamente
- **dismissing** = respingere
- **highly-charged** = ad alta carica emotiva
- **pottery** = tornio, ceramica
- **hungered for** = desiderare
- **fancy** = elegante
- **blues** = tristezza
- **dumb** = sciocca
- **Concerned** = preoccupato
- **wife-to-be** = futura moglie
- **paean** = inno
- **pilfered** = rubare
- **alongside** = accanto a
- **lead** = protagonista
- **tear-jerking** = strappalacrime
- **undying** = immortale, eterna
- **woos** = corteggiare, conquistare
- **theme** = colonna sonora
- **whomever** = chiunque
- **follow my lead** = reggere il gioco, assecondare
- **Ease** = alleviare
- **fall apart** = cadere a pezzi

- **prompting** = incitare, indurre
- **void** = vuoto